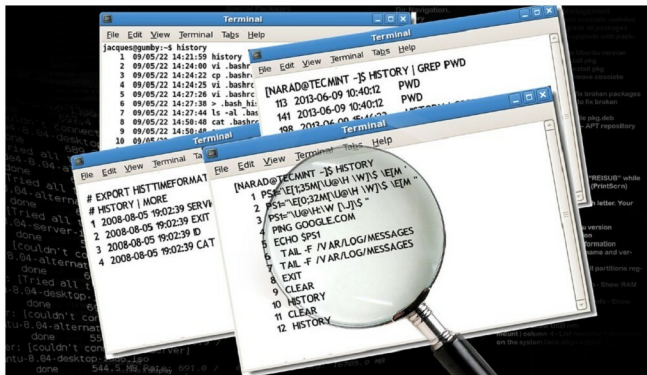


Use the History Command Effectively to Make Your Work Easier



Linux users have to make use of the command line at one time or the other. The History command saves them from repeatedly typing certain commands. This article will help readers to leverage the History operations available.

While working with the GNU/Linux environment, one is forced to spend some time on the command line. One is likely to repeat common commands often, and typing variations on those commands even more frequently. This can be good practice in the beginning but later it gets annoying and the repetition of commands slows one down.

Luckily, we can save some time with the use of the *History* command and its variations.

In this section, we will look at how we can explore this command. For this demonstration, I am using Ubuntu 14.04 LTS, but the process is the same for most GNU/Linux distributions.

Using the *History* command

The GNU/Linux History library is able to keep track of all the previously executed commands and this information can be helpful in writing new ones and executing them. The *History* command can be used to list a log of the commands you have typed.

This log is called the 'history'. And the command used to access it is *history*.

```
[bash]$ history
599 cat .bashrc
600 nautilus
601 vi
602 ls -l
```

In the above output, the former parameter is the command number in the History file and the latter is the actual command. This will list all the previously executed commands.

Typing '*history n*' will list the last '*n*' commands from the log.

The following command will list the last five commands from the history log.

```
[bash]$ history 5
599 cat .bashrc
600 nautilus
601 vi
602 ls -l
603 history
```